

Relationship between Processing Method and the Glycemic Indices of Ten Sweet Potato (*Ipomoea batatas*) Cultivars Commonly Consumed in Jamaica

This study investigated the effect of different traditional cooking methods on glycemic index (GI) and glycemic response of ten Sweet potato (*Ipomoea batatas*) cultivars commonly eaten in Jamaica. Matured tubers were cooked by roasting, baking, frying, or boiling then immediately consumed by the ten nondiabetic test subjects (5 males and 5 females; mean age of 27 ± 2 years). The GI varied between 41 ± 5 – 93 ± 5 for the tubers studied. Samples prepared by boiling had the lowest GI (41 ± 5 – 50 ± 3), while those processed by baking (82 ± 3 – 94 ± 3) and roasting (79 ± 4 – 93 ± 2) had the highest GI values. The study indicates that the glycemic index of Jamaican sweet potatoes varies significantly with the method of preparation and to a lesser extent on intravarietal differences. Consumption of boiled sweet potatoes could minimize postprandial blood glucose spikes and therefore, may prove to be more efficacious in the management of type 2 diabetes mellitus.